

2020s is an extraordinary era for AI development. The technology ~~renew~~ updates itself rapidly ~~and~~ and brought great social impact in very short amount of time. To address the challenge AI models can bring to media, Nesrine Malik wrote this opinion piece issued on ~~Guard~~ Guardian in ~~2023~~ 2025 April to present the reality distortion by AI to wide public. The potential audience are people who often focus on ~~real~~ world news. By employing artistic and ironic images and persuasive language, the author ^{tries to persuade readers} ~~expresses the conc~~ that AI is blurring the reality and subjectivity. ^{Good!}

Firstly, we ~~we~~ will take a look on the visuals. The title image showcases a pair of red glass ~~is~~ chaotic ^{and random} ~~brush~~ brush strokes. In contrast with the background, the lens depict peaceful bluesky. This ~~deliberate~~ ^{deliberate} contrast brought readers to realize the lens are not seeing what the reality really is. ~~This~~ This device effectively allows the author to express the "distortion" AI brought to ~~media~~ media and thus our perception of the world. Furthermore, the ^{felt} peace in the bluesky makes people ~~addictive~~ ^{and more easily believe in} to the fake reality ~~so~~: ^{The implication} ~~This impl~~ is clear: the AI distorted reality makes people obsessed with subjective fantasy, instead of reality. ~~And~~ This powerful visual reinforces the readers understanding of the presenting idea and makes a ~~per~~ intriguing hook to read more. ^{Good!}

Not only through thoughtful artworks, the author also includes ~~screen~~ ironic images to elaborate on the distorted reality. The selected screenshots of AI-generated videos depict Trump as an admired ~~person~~ ^{statue} and Elon Musk as a billionaire. The texture of the images, including the statue material, skin, and the lighting, demonstrate ironic ~~in~~ fake reality. ~~These are~~ Although and spread stereotypes of white supremacy, being fake, the author states these content bombard the internet, causing the readers to wonder the underlying identity reinforcement ~~and solid~~. Therefore, whether through ~~visual~~ artistic or ironic images, the author is able to ~~show~~ ^{present} the distortion power of AI that would make us further from reality.
it would be good to elaborate & situate why you think the use of these images are 'ironic' in relation to the points the writer is putting forward.

In addition to visuals, the author ~~utilizes~~ persuasive languages to address the destructive effect of AI on the media. ~~The~~ One way the author appeals to ethos is to use hyperlinks. These hyperlinks serves as citations ~~not to increase~~, so that readers can check these fact effortlessly and thus more easily believe the author. One example is that when author is explaining the ~~contr~~ genre of "rightwing political fantasy". By including links to videos ~~on~~ Trump's "made-up series" and "image of Dominican woman" comic, the author is able to ~~empty~~ effectively address the fact that AI-generated ~~fake~~ reality has great impact on politics and shapes social opinions.

To appeal to ethos, the author ^{uses} not only ~~uses~~ hyperlinks, but also quotes from experts.

Apart from ethos, the author carefully ~~see~~ chooses words to appeal to ~~to~~ pathos. In the title, "~~sleepwalking~~" "disaster" is used instead of "negative impact" or words that are moderate.

The extreme & negative sentiment suggests the readers the disastrous consequence of AI ~~and~~

media would brought to the world. This invokes fears in the readers, and also inspires ~~them~~ them

"Sleep walking" suggests the action was unware.

to read more ~~in~~. In addition, the author includes personal emotion in response ~~to~~ to some and take action to prevent the unintended disaster

facts. When talking about the widespreadness of AI content, the author employs the word "~~the~~

"struggle" ~~in describing~~ describing difficulty in verifying ~~the~~ truth of information. This

share of feeling resonates with the readers' experience, which builds closer connection between

the reader and the author. Hence, the author powerfully appeals to reader's ~~pathos~~ pathos

through ~~the~~ sensational diction, ~~and~~ persuade, effectively persuading the readers.

To conclude, ~~the~~ through a combination of visuals and text, the author efficiently

persuades and intrigues the readers. Images are used to allow readers grasp the main

message easily, while hyperlinks adds to the authenticity of the article. The sensational

diction adds more to these effects, allowing resonance between reader and author.

Although the author shows strong left-wing opinion in this critical article by showing how AI

Richard

^{propaganda}

contributes to the rightwing, ~~the~~ this opinion piece is ~~is~~ still inspiring and encourages the readers to dive deeper into the ~~ethic~~ problems of AI in media.

Good work Richard!

A . 4/5

B 4/5

C : 5/5

D : 5/5

18/20

Opinion

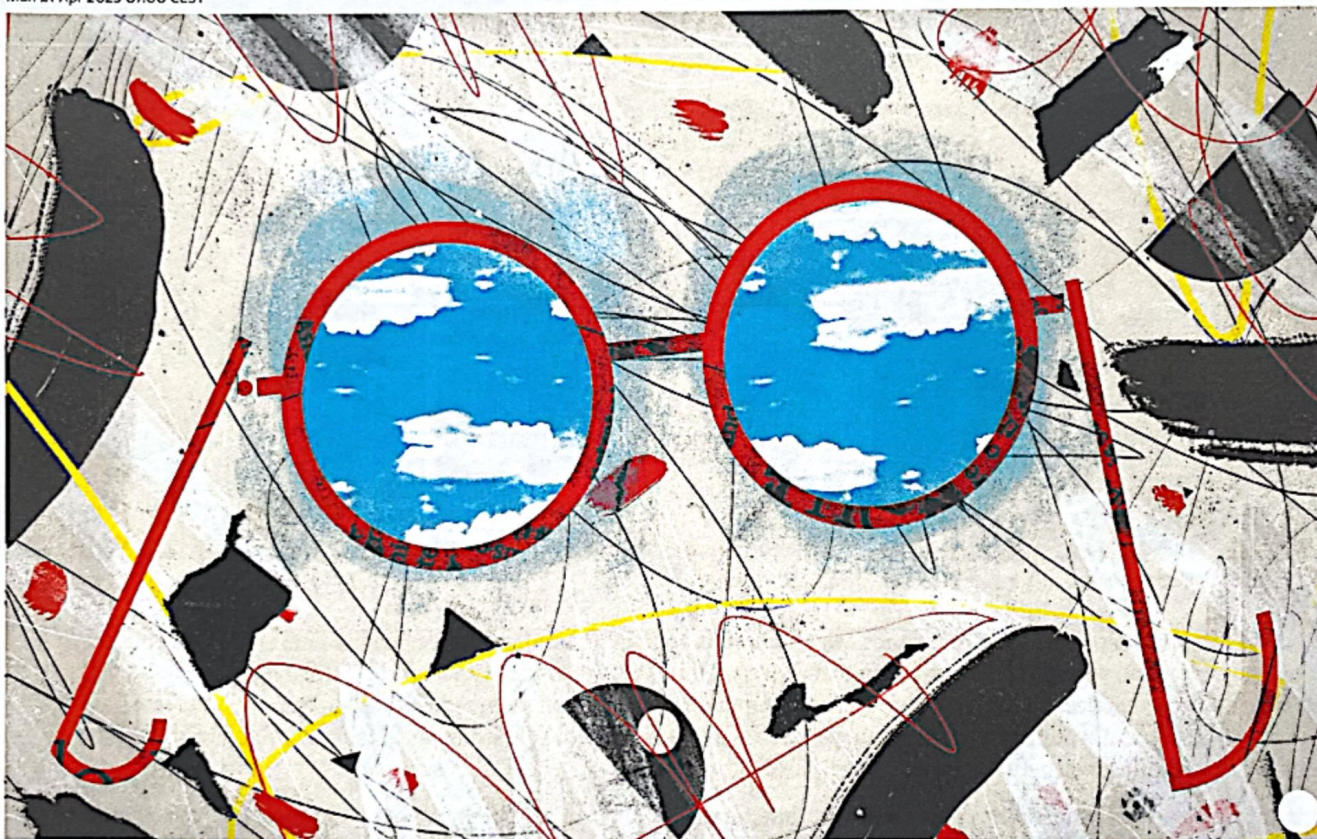
With 'AI slop' distorting our reality, the world is sleepwalking into disaster

Nesrine Malik



A perverse information ecosystem is being mined by big tech for profit, fooling the unwary and sending algorithms crazy

Mon 21 Apr 2025 07:00 CEST



There are two parallel image channels that dominate our daily visual consumption. In one, there are real pictures and footage of the world as it is: politics, sport, news and entertainment. In the other is AI slop, low-quality content with minimal human input. Some of it is banal and pointless – cartoonish images of celebrities, fantasy landscapes, anthropomorphised animals. And some is a sort of pornified display of women just simply ... being, like a virtual girlfriend you cannot truly interact with. The range and scale of the content is staggering, and infiltrates everything from social media timelines to messages circulated on WhatsApp. The result is not just a blurring of reality, but a distortion of it.

A new genre of AI slop is rightwing political fantasy. There are entire YouTube videos of made-up scenarios in which Trump officials prevail against liberal forces. The White House account on X jumped on a trend of creating images in Studio Ghibli style and posted an image of a Dominican woman in tears as she is arrested by Immigration and Customs Enforcement (Ice). AI political memefare has, in fact, gone global. Chinese AI videos mocking overweight US workers on assembly lines after the tariff announcement raised a question for, and response from, the White House spokesperson last week. The videos, she said, were made by those who “do not see the potential of the American worker”. And to prove how pervasive AI slop is, I had to triple-check that even that response was not itself quickly cobbled-together AI content fabricating another dunk on Trump’s enemies.

The impulse behind this politicisation of AI is not new; it is simply an extension of traditional propaganda. What is new is how democratised and ubiquitous it has become, and how it involves no real people or the physical constraints of real life, therefore

providing an infinite number of fictional scenarios.

The fact that AI content is also spread through huge and ubiquitous chat channels such as WhatsApp means that there are no replies or comments to challenge its veracity. Whatever you receive is imbued with the authority and reliability of the person who has sent it. I am in a constant struggle with an otherwise online-savvy elderly relative who receives and believes a deluge of AI content on WhatsApp about Sudan's war. The images and videos look real to her and are sent by people she trusts. Even absorbing that technology is capable of producing content with such verisimilitude is difficult. Combine this with the fact that the content chimes with her political desires and you have a degree of stickiness, even when some doubt is cast on the content. What is emerging, amid all the landfill of giant balls of cats, is the use of AI to create, idealise and sanitise political scenarios by rendering them in triumphant or nostalgic visual language.

Prof Roland Meyer, a scholar of media and visual culture, notes one particular "recent wave of AI-generated images of white, blond families presented by neofascist online accounts as models of a desirable future". He attributes this not just to the political moment, but to the fact that "generative AI is structurally conservative, even nostalgic". Generative AI is trained on pre-existing data, which research has shown is inherently biased against ethnic diversity, progressive gender roles and sexual orientations, therefore concentrating those norms in the output.



Donald Trump shares bizarre AI-generated video of 'Trump Gaza' - video

The same can be seen in "trad wife" content, which summons not only beautiful supplicant homemakers, but an entire throwback world in which men can immerse themselves. X timelines are awash with a sort of clothed nonsexual pornography, as AI images of women described as comely, fertile and submissive glimmer on the screen. White supremacy, autocracy, and fetishisation of natural hierarchies in race and gender are packaged as nostalgia for an imagined past. AI is already being described as the new aesthetic of fascism.

But it isn't always as coherent as that. Most of the time, AI slop is just content-farming chaos. Exaggerated or sensationalised online material boosts engagement, giving creators the chance to make money based on shares, comments and so on. Journalist Max Read found that Facebook AI slop - the sloppiest of them all - is, "as far as Facebook is concerned", not "junk", but "precisely what the company wants: highly engaging content". To social media giants, content is content; the cheaper it is, the less human labour it involves, the better. The outcome is an internet of robots, tickling human users into whatever feelings and passions keep them engaged.

But whatever the intent of its creators, this torrent of AI content leads to the desensitisation and overwhelming of visual palates. The overall effect of being exposed to AI images all the time, from the nonsensical to the soothing to the ideological, is that everything begins to land in a different way. In the real world, US politicians pose outside prison cages of deportees. Students at US universities are ambushed in the street and spirited away. People in Gaza burn alive. These pictures and videos join an infinite stream of others that violate physical and moral laws. The result is profound disorientation. You can't believe your eyes, but also what can you believe if not your eyes? Everything starts to feel both too real and entirely unreal.

Combine that with the necessary trivialisation and provocative brevity of the attention economy and you have a grand circus of excess. Even when content is deeply serious, it is presented as entertainment or, as an intermission, in a sort of visual elevator music. Horrified by Donald Trump and JD Vance's attack on Zelenskyy? Well, here is an AI rendering of Vance as a giant baby. Feeling stressed and overwhelmed? Here is some eye balm - a cabin with a roaring fire and snow falling

side. Facebook has for some reason decided I need to see a constant stream of compact, cutesy studio apartments with a variation of "this is all I need" captions.

And the rapid mutation of the algorithm then feeds users more and more of what it has harvested and deemed interesting to them. The result is that all media consumption, even for the most discerning users, becomes impossible to curate. You are immersed deeper and deeper into subjective worlds rather than objective reality. The result is a very weird disjuncture. The sense of urgency and action that our crisis-torn world should inspire is instead blunted by how information is presented. Here, there is a new way of sleepwalking into disaster. Not through lack of knowledge, but through the paralysis caused by every event being filtered through this perverse ecosystem - just another part of the maximalist visual and memetic show.

Nesrine Malik is a Guardian columnist

We know, we know, we know ...

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VISA



AI ~~not~~ blurs real and fantasy

~~objective~~ subjective

image: supremacy fantasy

condemn/irony → Trump / Mask → reinforce stereotype

text: persuasive (ethos)

- quote from prof ; links

sensationalism (pathos)

wordchoice

→ appeal to context

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Guardian Pick

My wife (who is far more clever than me) was happily explaining to me that because of AI and the proliferation of bullshit the only truly reliable stores of information left on earth are libraries stocked with books printed before January this year. She said January because that was when AI consumed all of human knowledge and started making up bullshit of its own to "train" upon. She called it the "John Colshaw problem".

Nobody knows w...

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